LESSON PLAN · SCRATCH (GR 3–5) BEGINNER: SCRATCH GAME MAKERS

Lesson 6: Project: Dance Party

Module 2 | 50 minutes | Project: loops + animation | Grades 3–5 · ages 8–10

Objective: Plan, build, test and share an animated dance party that uses loops, costumes, sound and backdrop changes.

Success criteria

- My dancers animate with forever loops.
- My party has a beat and changing backdrops.
- A click starts a show-stopper move made with a repeat loop.

Key vocabulary

- **parallel**: Happening at the same time.
- **backdrop**: The picture behind the sprites on the stage.
- **beat**: A sound that repeats regularly.
- **show-stopper**: A special move that happens on a click.

You will need

- Projector with Kitabash (lesson video, Code Lab)
- Devices: 1 per learner or pair
- Printed worksheet (optional)
- Printed project brief

Timed lesson plan (50 min)

Time	Stage	What happens
5 min	**Warm-up (unplugged)**	Human band: parallel loops and an event.
5 min	**Watch & plan**	Project video; students plan dancers, beat and lights on the brief.
25 min	**Build**	Dance-routine puzzle, then build the party in the Code Lab project.
7 min	**Test & peer feedback**	Party walk: visit two classmates' parties; two stars and a wish.
8 min	**Submit & reflect**	Improve one thing, write the reflection, submit.

Unplugged warm-up

Human band (5 min): group 1 claps every beat (forever), group 2 stamps every 2 beats, one student spins when tapped (click event). Start all together on "green flag!".

Teaching the idea

The project consolidates loops: several forever loops run in parallel (one per behaviour), and a repeat loop creates a finite move. Students also meet parallelism — all green-flag scripts start together.

Analogy: A band: each musician (script) plays their own part at the same time, and together it makes the song.

Live demo: Build the party live in three layers: dancer loop, then beat, then lights. After each, press the flag and ask: “Which loops are running now?”.

Questions to ask

Ask	Listen for
How many forever loops does your party have?	Usually 3+: dance, beat, lights.
Why do the scripts run together?	They all start on the green flag at the same time (parallel).
How did you make the spin end facing forward?	8 × 45 = 360, or a point in direction reset.

Differentiation

Support
Start from one dancer with the dance loop; add the beat as the second goal. Two dancers can share copied code.

Stretch
Make dancers take turns: one dances, then the next. Or use “when key pressed” to switch dance moves.

Common misconceptions

Misconception	How to fix it
I need one script that does everything	Separate forever loops for separate behaviours are easier and run at the same time.
A sound in a forever loop needs no wait	Without a wait, the sounds pile up; use a wait to set the beat.
Turning 45 eight times leaves the sprite tilted	8 × 45 = 360 degrees: back where it started.

Assessment

Project rubric (also on the project brief):

Criterion	1 · Beginning	2 · Developing	3 · Secure	4 · Excellent
Loops	No working loops	One loop works	Forever loops for dance, beat and lights	Loops combined cleverly (different speeds, repeat inside forever)
Animation	Sprites don’t animate	One dancer animates	All dancers animate smoothly with waits	Animations are varied and well-timed to the beat
Events	Only the green flag	A click does something	Each dancer has a click show-stopper	Uses flag, click and key events together
Creativity	Copies the example	Some own ideas	Own style for dancers, beat and lights	Surprising, polished party
Testing & reflection	Not tested	Tested a little	Tested by a friend; reflection explains a change	Fixed several issues; reflection explains learning

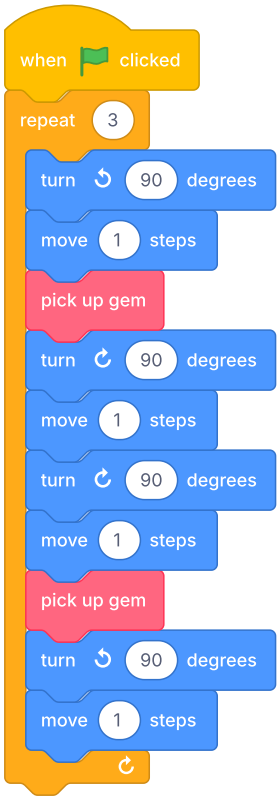
Exit ticket
Write the three forever loops your party uses, in words.

Homework
Show your party to someone at home. Teach them what a forever loop is.

Answer key — Kitabash activities

1. Dance routine (perform · block code)

One solution:

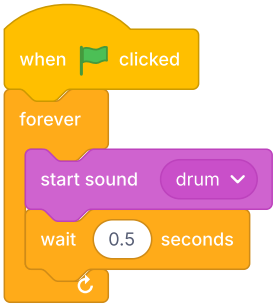


2. Match each block to its job in the party (perform · matching)

next costume → Shows the next dance pose · next backdrop → Changes the stage picture · start sound → Plays a beat · wait (0.5) seconds → Sets the speed of the loop

3. Keep the beat (perform · multiple choice)

Answer: A

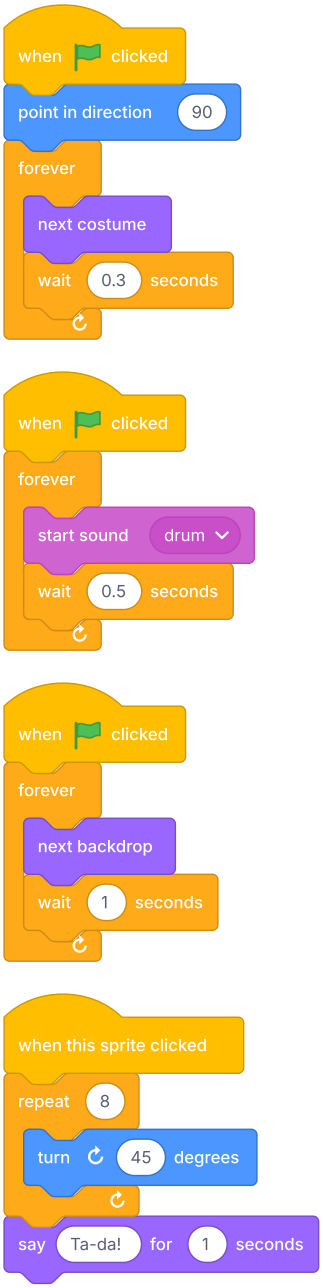


4. Project: Dance Party (probe · code lab)

Goals checked: 2 or more dancers · Dancers animate in a loop · A beat that loops · Changing backdrops · A click show-stopper

Example project:

Dancer



Dancer2



Answer key — worksheet

1. **My dancers:** Student plans.
2. **My loops:** At least dance, beat and lights.
3. **Spin maths:** 45 · 90 · 30
4. **Two stars and a wish:** Kind, specific feedback.

Kitabash original curriculum. Scratch is a project of the Scratch Foundation in collaboration with the MIT Media Lab; this course is not affiliated with or endorsed by them.